SOL PROTOCOL

Alpha Playtest: Feedback Form & Change List

From player feedback to a prioritised list of fixes and features

The Feedback Form

Playtest	Alpha build · May 2026
Platform	Meta Quest (Meta Store)
Output	Feedback analysis and change list (next section)

My role

I created the Alpha Playtest feedback form. By analysing the players' responses collected through it, I compiled the list of fixes and of the feedback received, which defined the work for the next update.

Form Structure

I structured the form around the main areas of the game. Each area has a mandatory 1–5 rating followed by two open questions on what players appreciated and what they did not, plus specific questions on the points the team most needed to validate (tutorial clarity, motion sickness, attack and defense management, warp system). It closes with open suggestions and a final verdict tied to the planned Early Access price.

- **Areas covered:** overall experience, tutorial, player and ship controls, ship management, combat, exploration, dungeons.
- **Question types:** 1–5 rating scales, open answers, final 1–5 star verdict.

The Form

Original form. Text and question order are unchanged; the layout is compacted for this document.



Sol protocol Alpha Playtest

Please note that this is an alpha build and **does not represent the final version of the product**. The game is still under development, and many features and assets are missing or incomplete. This test is meant to gather feedback on core systems such as controls, combat and exploration.

Your impressions on what works, what doesn't, and what you'd like to see improved are greatly appreciated. Your feedback at this stage is extremely valuable and will help shape the future of the game.

Thank you for taking the time to test it and share your thoughts.

If you want leave us your Discord ID or email here.
That way, we can contact you if we need any clarification.

Rate your experience*
○ 1 Orrible ○ 2 ○ 3 ○ 4 ○ 5 Fantastic

Which aspects did you appreciate the most? | **Which aspects did you not appreciate?**

Did you complete the tutorial? If so, how clear and easy to understand was it?"*
With this question, we seek to identify any potential issues in comprehension or missing information that may have affected your experience, during the tutorial.

Rate player and ship controls*
○ 1 Orrible ○ 2 ○ 3 ○ 4 ○ 5 Fantastic

Which aspects did you appreciate the most? | **Which aspects did you not appreciate?**

Were there moments where you experienced motion sickness?*

Rate your ship management experience*
○ 1 Orrible ○ 2 ○ 3 ○ 4 ○ 5 Fantastic

Which aspects did you appreciate the most? | **Which aspects did you not appreciate?**

Rate the combat system*
○ 1 Orrible ○ 2 ○ 3 ○ 4 ○ 5 Fantastic

Which aspects did you appreciate the most? | **Which aspects did you not appreciate?**

What do you think about the "Attack" management?*
Weapon selection, aim system, enemy traking, ...

What do you think about the "Defense" system management?*
Shield positioning, hit feedback, enemy attacks direction, ...

Rate the exploration*
○ 1 Orrible ○ 2 ○ 3 ○ 4 ○ 5 Fantastic

Which aspects did you appreciate the most? | **Which aspects did you not appreciate?**

Did you find the warp system intuitive?*
Use of the galactic map, trajectory calculation and alignment, ...

How interesting/fun would you rate dungeon exploration?*
○ 1 Orrible ○ 2 ○ 3 ○ 4 ○ 5 Fantastic

Which aspects did you appreciate the most? | **Which aspects did you not appreciate?**

Tell us what... Is your favourite part | **Tell us what... We must improve**

Tell us what... We should change | **Tell us what... You hope to see in future updates**

Your Final Verdict*
Considering your experience and a potential Early Access price range of 10–15 USD, how would you rate the game on the Meta Store?
○ 1 ★ ○ 2 ★★ ○ 3 ★★★ ○ 4 ★★★★ ○ 5 ★★★★★

Feedback Analysis & Change List

Date	21/05/2026
Source	Player responses to the Alpha Playtest feedback form
Target	Next major update, toward the Early Access release

From Feedback to Tasks

I grouped the responses by the same areas as the form, turned recurring issues and requests into concrete tasks, split them into fixes and new features, and ordered them by priority. The next update focuses on gameplay feel, UI/UX, tutorial flow, backend systems and overall polish for the Early Access release.

> **Main themes from the feedback**
>
> - **Controls & interactions:** imprecise grab area, height calibration, jump/crouch bindings, seat-belt exit.
> - **Onboarding:** confusion on multi-command actions, holo map hard to use in the tutorial.
> - **Readability of feedback:** missile lock-on, same sound for loot and enemies, tiny loot icons, unnoticed alarm button.
> - **Progression:** fixed ship energy and flat difficulty gave little sense of progress.
> - **Most requested features:** save game and wrist inventory.

Not everything listed is guaranteed to make it into the next build: some features and fixes are still experimental or time-dependent.

Change List

Planned change	Player feedback / reason
Gameplay & Controls	
Improve the overall controller feel and make interactions more natural	Button interactions will change so that players only need to press their hand on a button to activate it.
Rework player height handling (crouch and related states)	Some players had difficulties setting their proper height: the calibration and height setup will be reworked to be more intuitive.
Review controller bindings	As many players requested, jump and crouch get dedicated buttons instead of being tied to left-stick movement (Jump → likely A, Crouch → likely B).
Add controller prompts for interactions such as exiting seats	The seat-belt system used to exit chairs was not appreciated by players: exiting will also be possible by simply pressing a controller button.
Improve grab interactions and interaction points	The grab area is too imprecise. It will be narrowed so players can grab exactly what they want, even in hectic situations.
Tutorial	
Fix the tutorial structure to improve overall polish and onboarding clarity	—

Planned change	Player feedback / reason
Add substeps for complex mechanics	Players got confused too easily during actions that require multiple commands, so these will be split into smaller steps.
Fix missing tutorial lines and inconsistent panel sizes	Some lines were missing, and some panels were either too small or too large.
Prevent tutorial panels from overlapping gameplay elements	Panels must always be clearly visible without obstructing other important elements.
Improve tutorial panel transitions with SFX and animations	Sounds and animations when a step is completed, so players immediately understand what to do next.
Adjust turret tutorial panels positioning	They were simply placed incorrectly.
Verify and improve holo map zoom during tutorial sequences	Many players struggled to use the holo map correctly and locate the asteroid field. Holo map usage will be enforced more clearly, with better feedback on what to look for.
UI / UX	
Rework the gunner UI	Some gunner UI elements caused issues, especially missile lock-on feedback. Improve crosshair visibility and alignment, reduce oversized UI elements, add proper missile lock-on feedback.
Improve the energy panel	Two possible approaches, chosen on development time and player feedback (possibly a poll): holographic UI with discrete slider values, or flat UI with draggable sliders.
Optional vignette mode in the comfort settings	During the playtest the vignette settings were present but not functional. They will be implemented with multiple customisation options.
Combat & Enemy Behavior	
Fix enemies shooting through planets	Pilot skill becomes more important: flying through asteroid fields and around planets will help avoid getting hit.
Add collision/crash behavior for flock enemies hitting planets	Enemy ships avoided planets and asteroids too aggressively. Skilled piloting will be rewarded by making enemies crash during aggressive avoidance manoeuvres.
Improve enemy detection feedback	Enemies and loot used the same detection sound, and it was hard to tell what had been detected unless it was right in front of the ship. Differentiate loot and enemy SFX, possibly redesign the sound, add holo map pings for detected enemies.
Loot, Systems & Progression	
Improve loot visibility on the holo map	Loot icons were too small on the holo map. Loot in range will become much more noticeable.
Make system construction consume repair resources	Fixes an exploit that allowed free system repairs, and gives more tactical weight to building and managing systems.
Rename "Repair Sphere" into a nanobot-themed resource	Mainly for lore purposes.
Fix missing names on some mods/systems	Players reported missing names on mods or system chips.

Planned change	Player feedback / reason
Galactic Map & Navigation	
Mark already visited sectors	Visited sectors are already saved (loot does not respawn, enemies do), but the galactic map showed no difference between explored and unexplored sectors.
Give sector colors gameplay meaning (difficulty levels)	Sector colours were random. Colour coding (and possibly shapes) will give strategic information while travelling.
Ship & Internal Systems	
Fix alarm state replication and add proper labels/text	The armchair button that turns the ship alarm on or off went almost unnoticed by players.
Review and polish all in-ship text elements	—
Improve automa controls and related SFX/UI	Players must be warned when the automa is active and manual weapon control is unavailable.
Technical & Backend	
Investigate and fix server disconnection issues	—
Major backend improvements and internal system refactors	—
New Features	
Save game support	Highly requested by players. The game will save at the beginning of each new sector (or after a jump).
Wrist inventory system	Highly requested and already in development: pressing the wrist button with empty hands opens a mini inventory; a held item can be placed directly on the wrist or in a free slot.
Generator room gameplay (power cells)	With a fixed amount of ship energy there was no sense of progression. New loot type (batteries / power cells) and a generator room to raise energy capacity; runs start with much less energy.
System difficulty progression	All systems were roughly the same difficulty. Exploration will get progressively harder from sector to sector.
Expand Galactic Map information	Players will see enemy presence, loot availability and environmental danger before jumping, so they can choose their next move more carefully.

Development Priority (New Features)

1. **Galactic Map information + enemy difficulty progression.** Currently in development.
2. **Player wrist inventory.** In development in parallel, with different interaction solutions being tested.
3. **Save game system.** The biggest task; work starts only after the features above are finished.
4. **Energy progression + power cells as loot.** Being designed; implemented only after the save system, otherwise the game would be too hard to test properly during playtests.

Items 3 and 4 may not make it before the next playtest. Fixes from the change list are worked on in parallel with the new features.